NOVELIA

Every story deserves to be heard, read, and felt.

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Version 1.0 | Proposed MVP and product scope

Document field	Details
Product	NOVELIA — AI-powered global reading marketplace
Document type	Product Requirements Document (PRD)
Version	1.0
Status	Proposed — for stakeholder review
Primary user groups	Readers, book publishers, platform administrators
Core AI assistant	ROX
Primary platform	Responsive web application (initial release)

Prepared as a product concept based on the stated client requirements.

Document Control

Item	Description
Purpose	Define the product vision, users, scope, functional and non-functional requirements, business rules, user journeys, and success measures for NOVELIA.
Audience	Client stakeholders, product management, business analysis, UX/UI design, engineering, QA, and operations teams.
Scope note	This PRD contains proposed assumptions and recommendations where the client brief did not specify a decision. These must be validated before production development.
MVP approach	Build a web-first prototype with simulated transactions and sample data before implementing production payment, licensing, and advanced AI capabilities.

1. Product Overview

1.1 Product Vision

To make literature accessible across language barriers and create an immersive, personalized reading experience while empowering publishers to distribute, monetize, and understand their content globally.

1.2 Product Summary

NOVELIA is a multilingual digital reading marketplace connecting readers and publishers worldwide. Readers can discover, purchase, and read digital books, manage their libraries, participate in chapter-based discussions, and use ROX, an AI-powered assistant. Publishers can upload and manage books, monitor performance and earnings, and submit promotional campaigns through the Reach Readers feature.

1.3 Product Value Proposition

- Discover: Find books by title, author, genre, language, and other preferences.
- Experience: Read with optional instrumental background music and chapter-based community discussions.
- Manage: Use ROX AI to assist with reading, searching, purchasing reminders, publishing workflows, and analytics.
- Connect: Give publishers tools to distribute books and understand aggregate reader engagement.

2. Problem Statement and Objectives

2.1 Problem Statement

Readers may face language barriers when accessing international literature, have fragmented tools for managing purchases and reading progress, and lack immersive or chapter-specific community experiences. Publishers may lack an integrated platform for distributing digital books, monitoring sales and engagement, and requesting promotional support.

2.2 Product Objectives

- Provide a centralized marketplace for digital books and approved language editions.
- Make it easy for readers to discover, purchase, and manage books.
- Improve reading engagement through StorySound and Chapter Circle.
- Provide publishers with book management, sales, earnings, and engagement insights.
- Use ROX to simplify high-value reader and publisher tasks.
- Establish a scalable foundation for global distribution and future monetization.

3. Target Users and Personas

User type	Description	Primary needs
Global reader	A person who reads digital books and may prefer one or more languages.	Discover books, access preferred language editions, purchase, read, and manage a library.
Book enthusiast	A frequent reader who tracks progress and follows authors or genres.	Reading history, favorites, recommendations, upcoming releases, and community.
Independent author	An individual who publishes and sells their own work.	Upload and manage books, track performance, receive earnings, and promote books.
Publishing company	An organization managing multiple authors or titles.	Manage a catalog, schedule releases, analyze performance, and manage payments.
Platform administrator	An authorized NOVELIA operator.	Verify publishers, moderate content, approve books and campaigns, and oversee platform operations.

4. User Roles and Access

Role	Main capabilities
Reader	Browse books, purchase, read, manage library and preferences, join chapter discussions, use StorySound, and interact with ROX.
Publisher	Manage publisher profile and books, schedule releases, view analytics and earnings, submit Reach Readers campaigns, and use ROX.
Administrator	Manage users and publishers, approve books, review campaigns, oversee payments, moderate discussions, and monitor platform activity.

Access must be role-based. Readers must not access publisher or admin functions. Publishers must only manage their own organization and books. Administrators must have controlled access to operational and moderation functions.

5. Scope and Release Strategy

5.1 MVP Scope

- Reader, publisher, and administrator demo access and role-based navigation.
- Reader home, book discovery, search, filters, book details, library, favorites, and reading progress.
- Simulated book purchase and transaction history.
- Basic reading interface with bookmarks and automatic progress saving.
- StorySound with predefined, licensed or original instrumental tracks.
- Chapter Circle discussion popup and basic chapter-specific comments.
- Publisher dashboard, book upload form, book management, and basic analytics.
- Publisher earnings and payment history using sample or simulated data.
- Reach Readers campaign request submission and admin review.
- Basic role-aware ROX assistant with selected reader and publisher use cases.
- Basic admin functions for publisher, book, campaign, and community moderation.

5.2 Future Scope

- Production payment gateway integration and real publisher payouts.

- AI-assisted translation and publisher-approved multilingual editions.
- Advanced personalized recommendations.
- AI-generated or dynamically adaptive soundtracks.
- Advanced publisher analytics and reader segmentation.
- Automated notifications across email, push, and in-app channels.
- Audiobooks, social reading clubs, and author-reader events.
- Advanced digital rights management (DRM) and content protection.

5.3 Out of Scope for Initial Prototype

- Real-money payment processing.
- Guaranteed production-grade DRM.
- Unreviewed AI translation of complete commercial books.
- Autonomous AI actions that spend money or publish content without confirmation.
- Native iOS and Android applications.

6. Functional Requirements — Reader Portal

6.1 Authentication and Onboarding

- Readers can register using email and password.
- Readers can log in, log out, and recover a forgotten password.
- Readers can manage profile information.
- Onboarding allows selection of preferred reading language, genres, and interests.
- Readers can update language and notification preferences.

6.2 Book Discovery and Marketplace

- Browse available books by category, genre, popularity, and release date.
- Search by title, author, publisher, genre, language, and keyword.
- Filter by language, genre, price, and release date.
- View book cover, description, author, publisher, language, release date, price, and available editions.
- View ratings and reviews where enabled.
- Add and remove books from favorites or wishlist.
- View upcoming releases and follow books or authors.
- Display original and translated editions as distinct editions with clear language labels.

Language requirement clarification: the product must distinguish between a publisher-uploaded/approved translated edition and an AI-generated translation. The initial commercial release should prioritize authorized, publisher-approved editions.

6.3 Book Purchasing and Pricing

Readers can purchase individual digital books. The platform displays a launch price during the first seven days after a book's release and the regular price thereafter.

Pricing period	Proposed demo price	Status
First seven days after release	USD 2.00	Assumption for prototype; client confirmation required
After the first seven days	USD 4.00	Assumption for prototype; client confirmation required

- Calculate the applicable price using the book's release timestamp and configured promotional period.
- Display the price, applicable promotion, and order summary before checkout.

- Record purchase status and make successfully purchased books available in My Library.
- Show purchase confirmation and transaction history.
- Support transaction states such as pending, successful, failed, refunded, and cancelled in the production design.
- Real purchases must require explicit reader confirmation and secure payment processing.

6.4 Reader Dashboard

Dashboard section	Requirement
My Library	List all purchased and accessible books.
Reading Progress	Show current book, chapter, last-read position, and completion percentage.
Favorites	Show books saved as favorites.
Wishlist	Show books saved for future purchase.
Subscriptions	Show active, expired, and available subscription plans.
Payments	Show transaction history, status, amount, date, and receipt where applicable.
Upcoming Releases	Show followed books and upcoming launch dates.
Notifications	Show purchase, release, subscription, and community updates.
Reading History	Show recently opened and previously read books.

6.5 Reading Experience

- Open and read purchased books in a chapter-based reader.
- Support adjustable font size, light/dark themes, and readable typography.
- Support chapter navigation, bookmarks, and text highlighting where technically supported.
- Save reading position and progress automatically.
- Allow searching within the book by keyword or phrase.
- Allow the reader to switch between available authorized language editions.
- Ensure the reading experience is responsive on desktop, tablet, and mobile.

6.6 StorySound — Immersive Background Music

StorySound is an optional instrumental audio experience that allows readers to play background music associated with a book or chapter.

- Display an on/off control within the reading interface.
- Support play, pause, volume adjustment, and track selection where available.
- Associate predefined instrumental tracks or moods with individual chapters.
- Use non-lyrical music only in the initial feature scope.
- Change tracks at chapter transitions when a new chapter mood is configured.
- Pause or stop playback when the reader exits the book or disables StorySound.
- Respect the reader's audio preferences and avoid unexpected playback.

Story atmosphere	Example audio mood
Romantic	Soft piano or gentle strings
Mystery	Suspenseful ambient instrumental
Action	Cinematic instrumental
Sad or reflective	Emotional piano
Peaceful	Nature-inspired ambient

MVP recommendation: use a curated set of licensed or original audio tracks mapped to chapter moods. AI-generated adaptive soundtracks are a future enhancement.

6.7 Chapter Circle — Chapter Discussions

After a reader completes a chapter, the platform may display a discussion prompt: “Share your feelings till now before the break....”

- Display a popup after chapter completion.
- Allow readers to submit chapter-specific comments.
- Allow readers to view comments from other eligible readers.
- Support replies and reactions in a later MVP iteration if needed.
- Allow readers to skip the discussion and continue reading.
- Restrict discussion visibility to avoid spoilers from chapters the reader has not unlocked.
- Allow users to report inappropriate comments.
- Provide administrator moderation and content removal capabilities.

6.8 Reader Notifications

- Upcoming release reminders for followed books or authors.
- New release notifications.
- Purchase confirmations and payment status updates.
- Subscription renewal or expiry reminders.
- Replies and reactions to chapter discussions.
- Allow readers to configure notification preferences and frequency.

6.9 ROX AI — Reader Assistant

ROX is the in-app AI assistant. In the reader portal, ROX helps users discover, understand, search, and manage their reading activities.

Use case	Example prompt or action
In-book search	Find the chapter or passage containing a specific keyword.
Chapter lookup	Find the chapter where a named event or character interaction occurs.
Reading support	Explain a passage or summarize chapters the reader has completed.
Recommendations	Recommend books based on genres or reading history.
Purchase reminder	Remind me to purchase this book on Friday.
Reading insights	Show my reading progress this month.

- ROX must respect the reader's account permissions and purchased content access.
- ROX must respect reading progress and spoiler boundaries by default.
- ROX must ground book-related answers in available book content and identify uncertainty.
- Scheduled purchases must be reminders or pending actions; no payment may be charged without explicit confirmation.
- The prototype may use mock responses; production requires secure AI integration and usage controls.

7. Functional Requirements — Publisher Portal

7.1 Publisher Registration and Verification

- Support registration as an individual author or publishing organization.
- Collect publisher name, contact details, organization type, and relevant profile information.
- Allow submission of verification documents where required.
- Allow publishers to provide payout details through a secure process.
- Support pending, approved, rejected, and suspended verification states.

- Require approval before a publisher can make books publicly available.

7.2 Publisher Dashboard

- Display total books published and books awaiting approval.
- Display total units sold, gross revenue, estimated publisher earnings, and pending payouts.
- Display total and active readers where measurable.
- Highlight best-performing books and recent transactions.
- Display upcoming scheduled releases.
- Provide links to book performance and payment details.

7.3 Book Management

- Add a book with title, subtitle, description, author, genre, language, and metadata.
- Upload book cover and manuscript files in supported formats such as EPUB and PDF.
- Add chapter structure and chapter metadata.
- Set release date, launch price, and regular price.
- Configure StorySound track or mood by chapter where available.
- Save a book as draft and submit it for review.
- Edit book details subject to publication and approval rules.
- Archive or request removal of a book.
- View book approval status and administrator feedback.

Content retention rule: removing or delisting a book must not automatically revoke access for readers who already purchased it. The platform must define contractual, copyright, and legal exceptions before production.

7.4 Book Performance Analytics

Metric	Definition
Total sales	Number of completed purchases for the book.
Gross revenue	Total value of completed sales before deductions.
Publisher earnings	Amount payable to the publisher after commissions and adjustments.
Active readers	Readers who have recently engaged with the book, based on a defined activity window.
Completion rate	Percentage of readers who reach the defined completion point.
Chapter engagement	Reading activity or completion by chapter.
Ratings	Average rating and number of ratings, where enabled.
Favorites	Number of readers who saved the book.

7.5 Publisher Payments and Earnings

- Show total earnings and earnings by book.
- Show individual transactions with date, book, gross amount, commission, adjustments, and net amount.
- Show pending, processing, completed, failed, and reversed payout statuses where applicable.
- Allow publishers to view and download payment statements.
- Show platform commission and refund adjustments transparently.
- Provide payout history and payout details.

Illustrative revenue-share example: for a USD 4.00 sale and a 20% platform commission, the platform commission is USD 0.80 and the publisher share is USD 3.20 before any other applicable adjustments. The commission rate and settlement terms require client approval.

7.6 Reach Readers — Promotional Campaign Requests

Reach Readers allows a publisher to request promotional support from NOVELIA.

- Provide a Reach Readers action for each eligible book.
- Open a campaign request form with selected book, campaign type, target audience, target language/region, objectives, proposed dates, and optional notes.
- Allow publishers to submit and track campaign requests.
- Notify administrators when a request is submitted.
- Allow administrators to approve, reject, request changes, schedule, and close campaigns.
- Display campaign status to the publisher.

Campaign status	Meaning
Draft	Publisher has not submitted the request.
Submitted	Request has been sent to the platform.
Under Review	Administrator is evaluating the request.
Approved	Campaign is approved and can be scheduled.
Rejected	Request is declined with a reason where appropriate.
Active	Campaign is currently running.
Completed	Campaign has ended.

7.7 ROX AI — Publisher Assistant

Use case	Example prompt or action
Release scheduling	Schedule my new book for a specified date.
Sales analysis	Which of my books generated the highest revenue this month?
Engagement analysis	Analyze reader engagement and completion for my latest book.
Content support	Generate a draft book description from the supplied metadata.
Promotion planning	Suggest a campaign for my mystery novel.
Market insight	Which genres or languages show stronger engagement in my available aggregate data?

- ROX must only access data the publisher is authorized to view.
- Publisher analytics must distinguish measured results from AI-generated estimates or recommendations.
- ROX must not expose personally identifiable reader data unless a lawful, explicit product policy permits it.
- Actions such as scheduling a release or submitting a campaign require confirmation before execution.
- AI-generated descriptions and campaign content must be reviewable and editable before publication.

8. Functional Requirements — Admin Portal

Module	Requirements
User management	View, activate, suspend, and manage reader accounts according to policy.
Publisher management	Review verification details; approve, reject, or suspend publisher accounts.
Book moderation	Review submitted books; approve, reject, request changes, or delist content.
Payment oversight	Monitor transaction records, commissions, refunds, and publisher payout status.
Commission management	Configure platform commission and applicable business rules with audit history.
Promotion management	Review Reach Readers requests and approve, reject, or schedule campaigns.
Community moderation	Review reported comments, remove content, and apply moderation actions.
Notifications	Create and distribute platform announcements and operational notifications.
Analytics	Monitor marketplace activity, sales, readers, publishers, and engagement.

ROX governance	Configure approved AI capabilities, permissions, and usage policies.

9. Business Rules

ID	Business rule
BR-01	Readers must register or log in before purchasing a book.
BR-02	The launch price applies during the first seven days after the configured release time.
BR-03	The regular price applies after the launch promotional period ends.
BR-04	The regular price must be configurable; USD 4.00 is only a proposed prototype assumption.
BR-05	Purchased books must appear in the reader's library after successful payment confirmation.
BR-06	Reading progress must be saved automatically.
BR-07	Chapter discussions must be associated with a specific book and chapter.
BR-08	Discussion access must follow spoiler and chapter-access rules.
BR-09	Publishers may manage only books and data belonging to their own publisher account.
BR-10	Books must pass the required approval process before public availability.
BR-11	Publisher earnings must account for commissions, refunds, and adjustments.
BR-12	Reach Readers campaigns require administrator approval.
BR-13	ROX must follow role-based access and data privacy rules.
BR-14	ROX must not execute a purchase or charge a payment method without explicit confirmation.
BR-15	Translated editions must have appropriate distribution and translation rights.
BR-16	Delisting a book must not automatically remove access for existing purchasers, subject to legal and licensing obligations.

10. Key User Journeys

10.1 Reader — Purchase and Read a Book

1. Reader opens NOVELIA and logs in.
2. Reader selects a preferred reading language.
3. Reader browses or searches for a book.
4. Reader opens the book details page and reviews the available edition and price.
5. Reader proceeds to checkout and confirms the purchase.
6. The platform records the transaction and adds the book to My Library after successful payment.
7. Reader opens the book and starts reading.
8. Reader enables or disables StorySound.
9. Reading progress is saved automatically.
10. After completing a chapter, the Chapter Circle prompt appears.
11. Reader shares thoughts or skips the discussion.
12. Reader uses ROX to search for a passage or request assistance.

10.2 Publisher — Upload and Promote a Book

13. Publisher registers and submits required verification information.
14. Administrator reviews and approves the publisher.
15. Publisher opens the publisher dashboard.
16. Publisher adds book metadata, cover, manuscript, language, pricing, and release date.
17. Publisher saves the book as a draft and submits it for approval.
18. Administrator reviews and approves the book.
19. The book becomes available according to its release schedule.
20. Publisher monitors sales, earnings, and engagement.
21. Publisher submits a Reach Readers campaign request.
22. Administrator reviews the request and updates its status.
23. Publisher uses ROX to analyze performance or prepare promotional content.

11. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Performance	Pages and reading content should load efficiently; interactions should feel responsive under expected MVP load.
Security	Use secure authentication, authorization, and protected handling of user and publisher information.
Privacy	Collect only necessary data and provide transparent privacy and consent controls.
Scalability	Architecture should support growth in readers, publishers, books, and markets.
Availability	Readers should have reliable access to their purchased content, subject to service availability and rights.
Accessibility	Use readable typography, sufficient contrast, keyboard navigation, and accessible controls.
Compatibility	Support modern desktop and mobile browsers and responsive layouts.
Localization	Support multiple languages and a path toward regional currencies and formats.
Backup and recovery	Protect account, library, purchase, and publisher data with appropriate backup and recovery processes.
AI safety	Prevent unauthorized data access, clearly communicate uncertainty, and require confirmation for consequential actions.
Content protection	Apply appropriate copyright controls, access restrictions, and content protection measures.
Auditability	Record key administrative, payment, approval, and publishing actions.

12. Success Metrics and KPIs

KPI	Definition / purpose
Monthly Active Readers (MAR)	Unique readers active during a calendar month.
New Publisher Registrations	Number of new publisher accounts created.
Book Purchase Conversion	Percentage of eligible book detail visitors who complete a purchase.
Average Revenue per Reader	Revenue divided by active or paying readers, using a clearly defined period.
Book Completion Rate	Percentage of readers who reach the defined end of a book.
Chapter Discussion Participation	Percentage of eligible chapter completions followed by a discussion contribution.
StorySound Adoption	Percentage of active readers who use StorySound.

ROX Engagement Rate	Percentage of active users who interact with ROX.
Publisher Retention	Percentage of publishers who remain active over a defined period.
Repeat Purchase Rate	Percentage of purchasers who make another purchase within a defined period.

Proposed hypotheses for validation, not committed targets: 30% of active readers use StorySound; 20% participate in chapter discussions; 15% interact with ROX monthly; and 25% of first-time purchasers make another purchase within 30 days. Baselines and targets should be revised after user research and pilot data.

13. Risks, Dependencies, and Mitigations

Risk / dependency	Potential impact	Mitigation
Copyright and publishing rights	Unauthorized distribution or legal disputes.	Verify publisher rights and obtain appropriate agreements before publication.
Translation accuracy	Meaning, tone, or cultural context may be lost.	Prioritize publisher-approved translations and human review.
Payment fees and cross-border payouts	Low-priced books may have high relative transaction costs; payout complexity.	Validate payment providers, settlement rules, currencies, taxes, and pricing.
Publisher acquisition	Insufficient catalog reduces reader value.	Recruit publishers and secure quality content before broad reader acquisition.
Music licensing	Unlicensed tracks create legal exposure.	Use original, licensed, or appropriately royalty-free tracks with documented rights.
AI hallucination	ROX may invent book details or misstate analytics.	Ground responses in authorized source data and disclose uncertainty.
Community moderation	Spoilers, harassment, spam, and harmful content.	Provide reporting, moderation workflows, and community guidelines.
Content piracy	Unauthorized redistribution of digital books.	Assess DRM and access-control options appropriate to the business model.
Privacy and regulation	Non-compliance across jurisdictions.	Obtain legal review for privacy, consumer protection, tax, and digital-content obligations.

14. Open Questions and Decisions Required

Area	Question requiring stakeholder decision
Pricing	What is the regular price after the first seven days? Is the USD 2 launch price fixed across all markets?
Subscription	What does a subscription include: unlimited reading, monthly credits, exclusive content, discounts, or other benefits?
Revenue share	What percentage of each sale goes to the publisher and what fees or deductions apply?
Translation	Will NOVELIA support publisher-uploaded translations, AI translation, or both? Who approves translations?
Currencies and regions	Which launch countries, currencies, taxes, and payment methods are supported?
StorySound	Will tracks be selected by publishers, assigned from a curated library, or generated dynamically by AI?
Community	Are discussions public, limited to purchasers, or limited to readers who have completed the chapter?
Publisher verification	What documents and approval criteria are required for individuals and publishing companies?
Release scheduling	Can publishers schedule releases independently, or does every release require admin approval?

Reader analytics	What reader data may publishers access, and must analytics be aggregated or anonymized?
ROX autonomy	Which actions can ROX perform directly, and which require user confirmation?
Content removal	What happens to existing purchaser access when a publisher removes or loses rights to a book?

15. Prototype Acceptance Criteria

The initial interactive prototype is considered ready for stakeholder demonstration when the following conditions are met:

- A user can enter the application using a reader, publisher, or admin demo role.
- Reader and publisher navigation are visibly separated.
- A reader can browse sample books, view details, and complete a simulated purchase.
- A simulated purchased book appears in the reader's library.
- A reader can open a sample book, navigate chapters, and retain reading progress during the demo.
- StorySound can be switched on and off and plays an available demo track.
- The Chapter Circle prompt appears after a sample chapter is completed, and the reader can post or skip.
- ROX provides role-appropriate sample interactions and does not claim to execute unsupported actions.
- A publisher can create or edit a sample book and view sample sales and earnings.
- A publisher can submit a Reach Readers campaign request and see its status.
- An administrator can review sample publisher, book, and campaign submissions.
- The prototype clearly labels simulated purchases, sample analytics, and demo-only data.
- Primary screens are responsive and important controls have functional interactions.

16. Assumptions and Constraints

- The initial product is a responsive web application.
- USD 2.00 for the first seven days and USD 4.00 thereafter are illustrative prototype assumptions only.
- The revenue-share example of 80% publisher / 20% platform is illustrative only.
- The first prototype may use mock data and local storage instead of a production backend.
- No real payments or payouts are processed in the prototype.
- StorySound uses a small set of approved demo tracks.
- ROX may begin with mock responses before integration with a live AI model.
- Production launch requires legal, security, privacy, payment, content-rights, and operational review.

17. Recommended Product Roadmap

Release	Focus	Included capabilities
Release 1 — MVP	Validate core marketplace and reading experience.	Reader and publisher access; discovery; book details; simulated purchases; library; reading progress; StorySound; Chapter Circle; basic ROX; publisher book management; basic analytics; admin approval.
Release 2 — Enhanced	Enable real operations and stronger engagement.	Payment integration; publisher payouts; approved multilingual editions; release scheduling; Reach Readers workflows; notifications; advanced analytics; expanded ROX actions.
Release 3 — Scale	Expand personalization and global reach.	AI-assisted translation; personalized

		recommendations; adaptive soundtracks; audiobooks; advanced reader insights; broader global distribution.

18. Glossary

Term	Definition
ROX	Role-aware AI assistant available to readers and publishers.
StorySound	Optional instrumental background audio associated with a book or chapter.
Chapter Circle	Chapter-specific reader discussion experience.
Reach Readers	Publisher-initiated request for promotional support from NOVELIA.
MVP	Minimum Viable Product: the smallest product scope that can validate core value.
DRM	Digital Rights Management: technology and controls used to manage access to digital content.
Gross revenue	Total sales value before commissions, refunds, and other adjustments.
Publisher earnings	Amount due to a publisher after applicable commissions and adjustments.

19. Approval and Sign-off

The following stakeholders should review and approve the PRD before production development begins.

Stakeholder	Name	Approval / date
Client / Business Owner		
Product Manager		
Business Analyst		
Engineering Lead		
UX/UI Lead		
Operations / Finance		